v158th FW
STANDARDS & CODE OF CONDUCT

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This document supersedes all previous versions of the v158th FW Code of Conduct. Direct any inquiries to v158th FW WG/CC at marcelinev158th@gmail.com

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PURPOSE.

The Virtual 158th Fighter Wing Policy Directive 1-1 *Standards & Code of Conduct* establishes expected behavior of members of the Virtual 158th Fighter Wing and associates. This document describes conduct that is unique to v158th FW.

RESPONSIBILITY.

All pilots, onboarded personnel, and associates, shall be thoroughly familiar with and operate per procedures and policies set forth in this instruction and all applicable references. The policies and procedures in this Instruction are established to maximize mission accomplishment and safety through standardization. Deviations from these procedures are authorized only when sound judgement dictates that safety will be compromised unless a justifiable deviation is executed.

REVISIONS.

All pilots are encouraged to submit recommended changes, additions, and improvements to their respective Commanders. (WG/CC > WG/CV > OG/CC > SQ/CC)

RELEASING AND DISTRIBUTION.

This Instruction is cleared for public release and is available electronically via v158th FW share drive in v158th FW\Documents\Operating Procedures.

Table of Contents

Chapter 1 - General Policies.

Chapter 2 - Chain of Command

Chapter 3 - Staff Conduct.

Chapter 1

General Policies

1. Understanding.

1.1. Any staff admitted to the Virtual 158th Fighter Wing shall adhere to all policies and procedures described in this Instruction.

1.2. Deviations from these procedures shall be authorized only when sound judgement dictates that safety or operations will be compromised unless a justifiable deviation is executed.

1.3. All staff are encouraged to submit recommended changes, additions, and improvements to their respective Commanders. All staff shall be expected to ensure they are up to date on the Virtual 158th Fighter Wing Code of Conduct.

2. Operational Security (OPSEC).

2.1. Any staff admitted to the Virtual 158th Fighter Wing shall agree to not share information regarding Wing operations, communications, and documentation outside of the Wing.

2.2. The Virtual 158th Fighter Wing mirrors a real-world military unit, the 158th Fighter Wing. Though public and open source, policies and procedures mirrored from the Vermont Air National Guard, the 158th Fighter Wing, or other government agencies, shall not be redistributed without authorization.

2.3. Authorized material classifications and markings are as follows:

2.3.1. Sensitive (SENS.)
2.3.2. Non-Sensitive (N-SENS.)

2.4. Prohibited material classifications and markings are as follows:

2.4.1. Unclassified (U.)
2.4.2. Classified.
2.4.3. Confidential (C.)
2.4.4. Secret (S.)
2.4.5. Top Secret (TS.)
2.4.6. Special Access (SA.)

2.4.7. Sensitive Compartmented Information (SCI.)
2.4.8. Restricted (R.)
2.4.9. Restricted Data (RD.)
2.4.10. Formerly Restricted Data (FRD.)
2.4.11. Controlled Unclassified Information (CUI.)
2.4.12. For Official Use Only (FOUO.)
2.4.13. Cover Sheets (Blue, Red, Orange.)
2.4.14. No Foreign (NOFORN, NF.)
2.4.15. Proprietary Information Involved (PROPIN.)
2.4.16. Foreign Intelligence Surveillance Act (FISA, FISC, FISCR.)

3. Activity. Reference v158FWI 11-1.

4. Non-Mission Ready Status.

4.1. NMR status shall be applied to staff who have not completed:

4.1.1. Monthly hour requirements.
4.1.2. Mission Qualification Training.

4.2. Leave of Absence (LOA).

4.2.1. Wing staff are allowed to take LOA with periods and requirements as agreed upon by the informing staff member and Command respectively.

4.2.2. NMR status may be applied to pilots on an approved LOA no shorter than 31 days in duration.

5. Membership Requirements. All applicants and staff must possess a device capable of running the following software and hardware requirements.

5.1. Windows 11 Operating System.
5.2. Flight control hardware.
5.3. Discord software application.
5.4. vPilot.
5.5. Microsoft Flight Simulator 2024.
5.6. Microsoft Flight Simulator System Requirements.
5.7. IndiaFoxtEcho F-35 Lightning II.

Chapter 2

Chain of Command

1. Pay Grade. Pay Grade is a representation of rank, responsibility, and experience.

1.1. Grades utilized in increasing order.

1.1.1. Second Lieutenant (vO-1).
1.1.2. First Lieutenant (vO-2).
1.1.3. Captain (vO-3).
1.1.4. Major (vO-4).
1.1.5. Lieutenant Colonel (vO-5).
1.1.6. Colonel (vO-6).

1.2. Grade definitions.

1.2.1. Second Lieutenant.

1.2.1.1. Admitted applicant.
1.2.1.2. MQT student.

1.2.2. First Lieutenant.

1.2.2.1. MQT graduate.
1.2.2.2. MR pilot.
1.2.2.3. 10 F-35A flight hours.

1.2.3. Captain.

1.2.3.1. FLUG-4 graduate.
1.2.3.2. MR pilot.
1.2.3.3. >3 calendar months TIS.
1.2.3.4. 30 F-35A flight hours.

1.2.4. Major.

1.2.4.1. MCUG graduate.
1.2.4.2. IPUG graduate.
1.2.4.3. MR pilot.
1.2.4.4. >9 calendar months TIS.
1.2.4.5. 50 F-35A flight hours.

1.2.5. Lieutenant Colonel.

1.2.5.1. MR pilot.
1.2.5.2. >12 calendar months TIS.
1.2.5.3. 75 F-35A flight hours.

1.2.6. Colonel.

1.2.6.1. MR pilot.
1.2.6.2. >18 calendar months TIS.
1.2.6.3. 120 F-35A flight hours.

1.3. Grade Policy.

1.3.1. Staff shall not be promoted to a higher pay grade until a formal request has been submitted and an interview conducted.
1.3.2. Staff shall not "skip" pay grades under normal circumstances.
1.3.3. Staff pay grade promotion Time in Service and flight hour requirements may be waived by WG/CC should a higher staff position need to be filled.
1.3.4. Staff F-35 flight hours conducted and logged outside of v158th FW operations may be counted toward flight hour promotion requirements by a factor of one-half.

2. Staff Roles & Manpower. Staff belonging to the v158th FW will be organized into a chain of command and role structure adhering to the following.

2.1. VT01 Wing Commander (WG/CC).

2.1.1. One vO-6.
2.1.2. Wing operations overseer.
2.1.3. Publication author.
2.1.4. Website manager.
2.1.5. Financial respondent.
2.1.6. First in command (1IC).

2.2. VT02 Wing Vice Commander (WG/CV).

2.2.1. One vO-6.
2.2.2. Assistant wing operations overseer.
2.2.3. Publication author.
2.2.4. Primary public POC.
2.2.5. Second in command (2IC).

2.3. VT03 Operations Group Commander (OG/CC).

2.3.1. One vO-6.
2.3.2. Squadron command and operations supervisor.
2.3.3. Operational policy compliance and manpower manager.
2.3.4. SQ/CC POC.

2.4. VT04-05 Squadron Commanders (SQ/CC).

2.4.1. Two vO-5s.
2.4.2. MR pilot.
2.4.3. Squadron training and readiness supervisor.
2.4.4. Flight planner.
2.4.5. Squadron POC.

2.5. VT06-07 Squadron Operations Officers (SQ/DO).

2.5.1. Two vO-4s.
2.5.2. MR pilot.
2.5.3. Squadron operations and coordination supervisor.
2.5.4. Event coordinator.
2.5.5. Flight scheduler.

2.6. VT11-61 Flight Leads (#/FL)

2.6.1. Six vO-3s.
2.6.2. MR pilot.
2.6.3. Flight personnel mentor and supervisor.
2.6.4. Assigned flight leader.
2.6.5. Mission objectives and tasking manager.

2.7. VT12-VT66 Flight Wingmen (#/WG)

2.7.1. Thirty vO-2s.
2.7.2. MR pilot.

Chapter 3

Staff Conduct

1. **General Conduct.** All personnel shall be expected to:

    1.1. Conduct themselves in a professional and courteous manner at all times.
    1.2. Adhere to all v158th FW policies and instructions.
    1.3. Maintain integrity and honesty in reporting flight hours and mission accomplishment.
    1.4. Represent the v158th FW positively.
    1.5. Not participate in behavior that undermines morale, unit cohesion, or group reputation.

2. **Unacceptable Conduct.** Personnel behavior violations include, but are not limited to:

    2.1. Disrespectful or abusive language toward others.
    2.2. Dishonesty in flight hour reporting and mission accomplishment.
    2.3. Deliberate disregard for flight safety and SOP.
    2.4. OPSEC violation.
    2.5. Homophobia.
    2.6. Transphobia.
    2.7. Racism.
    2.8.
    2.9. Harassment.
    2.10. Discrimination.

3. **Disciplinary Procedures.** Discipline will be escalated depending on offense, fair to either party, and documented in compliance with GDPR policies.

    3.1. Written warning.

    3.2. Probation.

    3.3. Blackmark.

    3.4. Demotion.

    3.5. Expulsion.